

Linear Algebra Solutions

Question 1: Find Orthogonal Complement & Prove $w \cdot \tilde{w} = 0$

Theory: Orthogonal Complement

The **orthogonal complement** of a subspace W , denoted as $W^\perp$ (or $\tilde{W}$), is the set of all vectors that are orthogonal (perpendicular) to every vector in W .

Definition: $W^\perp = \{v \in V : v \cdot w = 0 \text{ for all } w \in W\}$

Key Properties:

1. $W^\perp$ is always a subspace
2. $\dim(W) + \dim(W^\perp) = n$ (dimension of the full space)
3. $(W^\perp)^\perp = W$
4. $W \cap W^\perp = \{0\}$

Problem Setup (3×3 Example)

Let's find the orthogonal complement of a subspace W in $\mathbb{R}^3$.

Given: W is spanned by vectors:

- $v_1 = [1, 2, 1]$
- $v_2 = [0, 1, 1]$

Step 1: Set up the orthogonality condition

A vector $x = [x, y, z]$ is in $W^\perp$ if:

- $x \cdot v_1 = 0$
- $x \cdot v_2 = 0$

Step 2: Write the system of equations

From $v_1 \cdot x = 0$: $x + 2y + z = 0$ From $v_2 \cdot x = 0$: $y + z = 0$

Step 3: Solve the system

From equation 2: $z = -y$

Substitute into equation 1:

$$x + 2y + (-y) = 0$$

$$x + y = 0$$

$$x = -y$$

Step 4: Parametric solution

Let $y = t$ (parameter), then:

- $x = -t$
- $y = t$
- $z = -t$

$$\mathbf{x} = t[-1, 1, -1]$$

Result: $W^\perp = \text{span}\{[-1, 1, -1]\}$

Proof that $\mathbf{w} \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{w}} = 0$

Theorem: If $\mathbf{w} \in W$ and $\mathbf{u} \in W^\perp$, then $\mathbf{w} \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$

Proof:

1. Let $\mathbf{w}$ be any vector in W . Then $\mathbf{w}$ can be written as: $\mathbf{w} = c_1\mathbf{v}_1 + c_2\mathbf{v}_2 + \dots + c_k\mathbf{v}_k$ (linear combination of basis vectors of W)
2. Let $\mathbf{u}$ be any vector in $W^\perp$. By definition of $W^\perp$: $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v}_i = 0$ for all basis vectors $\mathbf{v}_i$ of W
3. Now compute $\mathbf{w} \cdot \mathbf{u}$: $\mathbf{w} \cdot \mathbf{u} = (c_1\mathbf{v}_1 + c_2\mathbf{v}_2 + \dots + c_k\mathbf{v}_k) \cdot \mathbf{u}$
4. Using distributivity of dot product: $= c_1(\mathbf{v}_1 \cdot \mathbf{u}) + c_2(\mathbf{v}_2 \cdot \mathbf{u}) + \dots + c_k(\mathbf{v}_k \cdot \mathbf{u})$
5. Since $\mathbf{u} \in W^\perp$, each $\mathbf{v}_i \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$: $= c_1(0) + c_2(0) + \dots + c_k(0) = 0$

Therefore, $\mathbf{w} \cdot \mathbf{w}^\perp = 0$ for all $\mathbf{w} \in W$ and $\mathbf{w}^\perp \in W^\perp$ ■

Verification for our example:

- $\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{v}_1 = [1, 2, 1]$
- $\mathbf{w}^\perp = [-1, 1, -1]$
- $\mathbf{w} \cdot \mathbf{w}^\perp = (1)(-1) + (2)(1) + (1)(-1) = -1 + 2 - 1 = 0 \checkmark$

Question 2: Gram-Schmidt Process

Theory: Gram-Schmidt Orthogonalization

The **Gram-Schmidt process** converts a set of linearly independent vectors into an orthogonal (or orthonormal) set that spans the same subspace.

Purpose: Create an orthogonal basis from any basis

Formula: For vectors $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$:

- $u_1 = v_1$
- $u_2 = v_2 - \text{proj}(u_1)v_2 = v_2 - [(v_2 \cdot u_1)/(u_1 \cdot u_1)]u_1$
- $u_3 = v_3 - \text{proj}(u_1)v_3 - \text{proj}(u_2)v_3$
- And so on...

For orthonormal basis: normalize each u_i by dividing by its magnitude: $e_i = u_i/\|u_i\|$

Problem 1: 3×3 Matrix (3 vectors in $\mathbb{R}^3$)

Given vectors:

- $v_1 = [1, 1, 0]$
- $v_2 = [1, 0, 1]$
- $v_3 = [0, 1, 1]$

Step 1: $u_1 = v_1$ $u_1 = [1, 1, 0]$

Step 2: Compute u_2

$$\text{proj}(u_1)v_2 = [(v_2 \cdot u_1)/(u_1 \cdot u_1)]u_1$$

$$v_2 \cdot u_1 = (1)(1) + (0)(1) + (1)(0) = 1$$

$$u_1 \cdot u_1 = 1^2 + 1^2 + 0^2 = 2$$

$$\text{proj}(u_1)v_2 = (1/2)[1, 1, 0] = [1/2, 1/2, 0]$$

$$u_2 = v_2 - \text{proj}(u_1)v_2 = [1, 0, 1] - [1/2, 1/2, 0]$$

$$u_2 = [1/2, -1/2, 1]$$

Step 3: Compute u_3

$$\text{proj}(u_1)v_3 = [(v_3 \cdot u_1)/(u_1 \cdot u_1)]u_1$$

$$v_3 \cdot u_1 = (0)(1) + (1)(1) + (1)(0) = 1$$

$$\text{proj}(u_1)v_3 = (1/2)[1, 1, 0] = [1/2, 1/2, 0]$$

$$\text{proj}(u_2)v_3 = [(v_3 \cdot u_2)/(u_2 \cdot u_2)]u_2$$

$$v_3 \cdot u_2 = (0)(1/2) + (1)(-1/2) + (1)(1) = 1/2$$

$$u_2 \cdot u_2 = (1/2)^2 + (-1/2)^2 + 1^2 = 1/4 + 1/4 + 1 = 3/2$$

$$\text{proj}(u_2)v_3 = (1/2)/(3/2) \times [1/2, -1/2, 1] = (1/3)[1/2, -1/2, 1] = [1/6, -1/6, 1/3]$$

$$u_3 = v_3 - \text{proj}(u_1)v_3 - \text{proj}(u_2)v_3$$

$$u_3 = [0, 1, 1] - [1/2, 1/2, 0] - [1/6, -1/6, 1/3]$$

$$u_3 = [0 - 1/2 - 1/6, 1 - 1/2 + 1/6, 1 - 0 - 1/3]$$

$$u_3 = [-2/3, 2/3, 2/3]$$

Orthogonal basis:

- $u_1 = [1, 1, 0]$
- $u_2 = [1/2, -1/2, 1]$
- $u_3 = [-2/3, 2/3, 2/3]$

To make orthonormal, normalize:

$$e_1 = u_1/\|u_1\| = [1, 1, 0]/\sqrt{2} = [1/\sqrt{2}, 1/\sqrt{2}, 0]$$

$$e_2 = u_2/\|u_2\| = [1/2, -1/2, 1]/\sqrt{(3/2)} = [1/\sqrt{6}, -1/\sqrt{6}, 2/\sqrt{6}]$$

$$e_3 = u_3/\|u_3\| = [-2/3, 2/3, 2/3]/\sqrt{(4/9+4/9+4/9)} = [-1/\sqrt{3}, 1/\sqrt{3}, 1/\sqrt{3}]$$

Problem 2: 4×4 Matrix (4 vectors in $\mathbb{R}^4$)

Given vectors:

- $v_1 = [1, 0, 0, 0]$
- $v_2 = [1, 1, 0, 0]$
- $v_3 = [1, 1, 1, 0]$
- $v_4 = [1, 1, 1, 1]$

Step 1: $u_1 = v_1$ $u_1 = [1, 0, 0, 0]$

Step 2: Compute u_2

$$v_2 \cdot u_1 = 1, u_1 \cdot u_1 = 1$$

$$\text{proj}(u_1)v_2 = 1 \times [1, 0, 0, 0] = [1, 0, 0, 0]$$

$$u_2 = [1, 1, 0, 0] - [1, 0, 0, 0] = [0, 1, 0, 0]$$

Step 3: Compute u_3

$$v_3 \cdot u_1 = 1, \text{proj}(u_1)v_3 = [1, 0, 0, 0]$$

$$v_3 \cdot u_2 = 1, u_2 \cdot u_2 = 1, \text{proj}(u_2)v_3 = [0, 1, 0, 0]$$

$$u_3 = [1, 1, 1, 0] - [1, 0, 0, 0] - [0, 1, 0, 0] = [0, 0, 1, 0]$$

Step 4: Compute u_4

$$v_4 \cdot u_1 = 1, \text{proj}(u_1)v_4 = [1, 0, 0, 0]$$

$$v_4 \cdot u_2 = 1, \text{proj}(u_2)v_4 = [0, 1, 0, 0]$$

$$v_4 \cdot u_3 = 1, \text{proj}(u_3)v_4 = [0, 0, 1, 0]$$

$$u_4 = [1, 1, 1, 1] - [1, 0, 0, 0] - [0, 1, 0, 0] - [0, 0, 1, 0] = [0, 0, 0, 1]$$

Orthogonal basis:

- $u_1 = [1, 0, 0, 0]$
- $u_2 = [0, 1, 0, 0]$
- $u_3 = [0, 0, 1, 0]$
- $u_4 = [0, 0, 0, 1]$

Note: This particular set of vectors already produced the standard basis! They're already orthonormal.

Key Properties of Gram-Schmidt:

1. **Preserves span:** $\text{span}\{u_1, \dots, u_k\} = \text{span}\{v_1, \dots, v_k\}$ for all k
2. **Creates orthogonal set:** $u_i \cdot u_j = 0$ for $i \neq j$
3. **Works for any inner product space**
4. **Can be numerically unstable** (modified Gram-Schmidt is more stable)

Applications:

- QR decomposition
- Solving least squares problems
- Computing orthonormal bases for vector spaces
- Signal processing and Fourier analysis